

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 4 2

♥ 9 8 5

♦ 10 9 7

♣ A 4

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K 5 2

♣ K Q J 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 8 7

♥ 10 7 6 4 2

♦ A 6 4 3

♣ 7

♠ A J 5

♥ K Q

♦ Q J 8

♣ 10 9 8 5 3

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

3 ♣

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠ K

[showcards W:SK E:S7 S:S5 N:S3]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠ K, East played the ♠ 7 and South the ♠ 5.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♦ 10, NOT another ♠.

You can see the ♠ 6, ♠ 5, ♠ 4, ♠ 3 and ♠ 2. So the ♠ 7 is East's lowest ♠, he is doing his best to discourage you from leading the suit again.

South held up with ♠ A J x, hoping you would play the suit again and give him two tricks.

If you play the ♦ 10 East will win the ♦ A and return a ♠, allowing you to drive out South's ♠ A while you still have the ♣ A for an entry.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 4 2

♥ 9 8 5

♦ 10 9 7

♣ A 4

♠ 6 3

♥ A J 3

♦ K 5 2

♣ K Q J 6 2



♠ J 7 5

♥ 10 7 6 4 2

♦ A 6 4 3

♣ 7

♠ A 9 8

♥ K Q

♦ Q J 8

♣ 10 9 8 5 3

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

3 ♣

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠K

There IS another possibility if South is a better than average Declarer. East just might hold ♠ 9 7, giving South ♠ A J 8 5. South played the ♠ 8 as a falsecard to tempt you into playing the suit again. This isn't too likely, but if it happens just congratulate South for the fine play.

[showcards W:SK E:S7 S:S8 N:S3]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠K, East played the ♠7 and South the ♠8.

What do you play to the second trick?

Play the ♠4.

You cannot see the ♠5. The most likely reason is that East has it, and his ♠7 is an encouraging signal. The only reason he would encourage you is if he held either the ♠A or ♠J.

Together, you two continue to play ♠s to drive out South's ♠A. When you get the lead with your ♣A you will cash your ♠ winners and East will still have the ♦A for some icing on the cake.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 5 4
♥ 6 4
♦ J 7 3
♣ A K Q 6 5 3

♠ A 10 7 2

♥ K J 8 3

♦ Q 8 6

♣ J 4



♠ K 8 6 3

♥ Q 10

♦ 10 9 5 4 2

♣ 8 2

♠ Q J 9

♥ A 9 7 5 2

♦ A K

♣ 10 9 7

West	North	East	South
			1 ♥
2 ♣	3 ♣	Pass	4 ♥
All Pass			
4 ♥ by South			
Lead: ♣ A			

[showcards W:CA N:C4]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣ A, dummy played the ♣ 4

Play the ♣ 8 to encourage a continuation. West will play the ♣ Q on which you will play the ♣ 2.

West now knows you started with a doubleton, and more importantly, he also knows you want him to play a third ♣.

When he next plays the ♣ K dummy will ruff, but whatever card he ruffs with you will have established a trump trick. When you later win your ♠ K that will be down 1.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 3
♥ J 8 4 3
♦ K J 9 5 2
♣ 8 2

♠ J 8 4

♥ 7 6 2

♦ 8 4

♣ K J 9 6 5



♠ Q 10 9 6 2

♥ 10 9

♦ Q 7 3

♣ A 7 4

♠ A K 5

♥ A K Q 5

♦ A 10 6

♣ Q 10 3

West	North	East	South
			2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♦5			

[showcards S:CQ]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♦5, East wins the ♦Q and returns the ♦7. South holds up his ♦A until the third round. He then plays the ♣Q

Play the ♣8.

You assume (hope) that East holds the ♣A. If he does then he will need help from you to decide which trick he should win. You play the ♣8 first, and the ♣2 next to show an even number.

If East is paying attention he will know to win the THIRD ♣. This will kill dummy's ♣ suit, and with it South's chance of making 9 tricks.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 7 6 5 2

♥ 3

♦ 10 6 4

♣ A K 10 5

♠ A

♥ K 10 8 2

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ J 8 6 2



♠ Q 10 8 4

♥ Q J 9

♦ K 9 5 2

♣ 9 3

♠ K 9 3

♥ A 7 6 5 4

♦ J 8

♣ Q 7 4

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♦

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

2 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

Lead: ♣A

[showcards W:CA N:C2]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣A, dummy played the ♣2

Play the ♣3.

If you signal with the ♣9 West will continue with the ♣K and another which you will have to ruff. You will give up your NATURAL trump trick by doing so. Worse, you will allow North's ♣J to be established as a winner that South can later discard a ♦ on.

Much better to play low. Partner will surely switch to a ♦, and South will probably finesse, though it doesn't matter whether he does or not. You will win the ♦K, return the ♣9 back to West's ♣K, and still have your trump trick for later.